FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-26-19001

Issue Title : Auxiliary Power Unit (APU) Tailpipe Overheat Detector Element Braze Corrosion

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2615-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
06/12/2019	04/09/2024	04/01/2024

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date
07/30/2024	06/30/2024

Revision Description

No update.

Description

Boeing 737NG operators have reported APU Tailpipe Fire Detector Assembly braze corrosion, which leads to broken detector terminal studs and/or failure of the braze. This results in moisture intrusion through pressure cycling, leading to corrosion and failure of the detector's pressure switches. This causes APU Fire Detector Inoperative annunciations on the Flight Deck.

When removing APU Tailpipe Fire Detector Assemblies with braze corrosion, the braze will sometimes fail, causing the terminal stud and ceramic to separate from the assembly, appearing as misuse or abuse of the detector.

Meggitt has performed analysis of several failed detectors and has attributed the braze failures to Fluorine contamination.

Meggitt has confirmed that Fluorine and Fluorides are not used during manufacture of the detector.

Boeing has consulted with De-Ice and Anti-Icing Fluid manufacturers and has verified that Fluorine and Fluorides are not compounds used in those fluids. These manufacturers have commented that Fluorine and Fluorides are typically added to local water supplies.

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Several 737 MAX operators have reported water accumulation in the Tail Cone area near the detector during Parking/Storage. This may be a contributor. FTD 737MAX-FTD-49-20002 addresses water accumulation in this area.

Status

Boeing will conduct laboratory testing a corroded detector in an effort to verify potential cause of contamination or corrosion. Boeing has currently received a unit from Meggitt and is working on a test plan.

Further information will be provided in a future update to this article.

Interim Action

In the case of faulty detector terminal studs and/or braze, Boeing recommends to remove and replace.

Final Action

Final action is dependent on the outcome of the testing and once a root cause is identified.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: February 2019 (Complete)

Solution Selected: February 2019 (Complete)

Boeing Laboratory Testing: March 2024 (Target)

Change Committed: TBD

In-service Instructions: TBD after Change Committed

Parts Available: TBD after Change Committed

Reference Categories

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Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	26-15-01		
Fleet Team Economic (FTE)	ISE-26-18-24307		
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737MAX-FTD-49-20002		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
APU Tailpipe Overheat Detector Element		Meggitt	8980-03

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- Dispatch Reliability Issues : Issues that cause revenue flight delays and cancellations
- Fleet Team IdeaXchange : Topic of discussion on the Fleet Team IdeaXchange bulletin board
- Flight Deck Effects and Maintenance Messages : Issue that occurs frequently and causes a flight deck effect or maintenance message

Attachments:

a) 737 APU Overheat Det 1.jpg

b) 737 APU Overheat Det 2.jpg

c) 737 APU Overheat Det 3.jpg

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